

Alienware 16X Aurora 2026

Powerful and gorgeous, but at what cost

My entire life revolves around laptops. This isn't only because I test them for a living, but because I also find myself using them the entire day. At work, I am busy with Chrome, juggling dozens of tabs, documents, calls, and much more. Once at home, I spend most of my time gaming. Now, when I sit down to unwind with my favorite titles after a long day, I really don't want to worry about whether my laptop will be able to handle the load. I actually want the laptop to disappear into the background and let the game take over. So, of course, a good display, design, build, strong performance, and portability matter to me. When I started using the new Alienware 16X Aurora, it felt like it could strike a sweet spot across all of these areas.

There is one thing that is hard to ignore: the hefty price tag of Rs 3,27,390. So, is the Alienware 16X Aurora worth spending close to Rs 3.3 lakh? Time to find out.

DESIGN AND BUILD

The Alienware 16X Aurora does not try to hide what it is. The laptop comes in an Interstellar Indigo colour, which is a really dark shade of blue that looks different than your usual black and white laptops. The Alienware branding on the lid makes it clear that this is built for gaming. The design does not rely on an excessive amount of RGB lighting or sharp angles to make a statement, which is the case with several Alienware laptops out there. In a nutshell, the Aurora 16X still has the Alienware character, but it can also sit on a desk

₹3,27,390



without looking completely out of place when you are using it for work.

As for the build, it is sturdy and premium, which is what you would expect from a gaming laptop at this price. There was some flex when I put pressure on the lid, but it isn't too much.

This is, however, a large machine and not something I would casually hold in one hand and go about my day. But, considering the kind of power this thing holds, it is justified. I still carried the 16X Aurora to work every day in my large tote bag and didn't feel like the weight of the world was on my shoulders. There is some context to that, though.

I drive to work. So, my carrying was mostly limited to the short walk between my car and my desk, and then back home. In case you use public transport or have a long commute on foot, the size and weight could become a much bigger consideration. As far as my routine is concerned, it was manageable.

KEYBOARD AND PORTS

I am generally fond of mechanical keyboards and use one in my home setup, so my expectations from gaming laptop keyboards are usually high. And the Alienware 16X Aurora meets those expectations. Well, almost. The keys are responsive and comfortable to press, making it easy to spend long hours typing. There is a dedicated Copilot key, along with shortcuts for screen brightness, keyboard backlighting, screenshots, and switching to performance mode. That said, I miss the mechanical feel that you get on other Alienware laptops, but if you prefer quieter keys, you are going to love the experience.

The backlighting can be customised through Alienware Command Center and is bright enough to get noticed in a well-lit room. One important thing, the backlight here is one-zone. This means that you can only apply one colour to the entire keyboard.

Coming to the trackpad, it is decent but definitely has scope for improvement. It is not really large, but it supports multi-touch gestures and works well enough for regular navigation. My bigger issue with it was the slightly plasticky feel and the amount of force needed to register a click. If you are rely on a trackpad instead of a mouse, things might get annoying.

Moving on to the ports, you get quite a decent number of options here. At the back of the laptop, there is a charging port, two USB Type-C ports, an HDMI port, and a USB Type-A port. On the left edge, you get an RJ-45 Ethernet port, a USB Type-A port, and a headphone jack. I like the fact that the ports are located at the back as well as the left edge.

PERFORMANCE

The Alienware 16X Aurora is equipped with an Intel Core Ultra 9 290HX Plus chip, 32GB of DDR5 memory, and an Nvidia GeForce RTX 5070 laptop GPU with 8GB of GDDR7 VRAM.

Now, for regular office work, this is far more power than I need. I had sev-